

SURREY SCOUT

FEBRUARY, 1978

No. 370

County Chairman

An invitation from the Industrial Society, to speak at a conference at a Technical College in Kent in October on industry and commerce, prompted me to think anew of the gap between business and education.

The conference itself was most stimulating. It was attended by some 200 students between the ages of 17 and 25, who displayed a vigorous interest in the problems of management and of productive operation, and provided me with a welcome reassurance that there are plenty of young men and women of ability who are ready and enthusiastic to participate in industrial and commercial activity and who have the skills and qualifications which are required in the immediate future.

The occasion also served to remind me of the evident lack of understanding in the world of education, of the realities of work in the business atmosphere. The problem is well-known and in no way surprising when one recognises the lack of opportunity for teachers and university lecturers to have personal experience in industry. The reverse applies - that few industrial managers have teaching experience.

However the exception to the latter statement is to be found among Scouters and other youth leaders whose organisations have a formal learning programme as the basis of activities. Furthermore, there are many former Scouters who, for a variety of reasons, have had to exchange an active leader role for that of adult supporter. Such of these people, as have management or supervisory experience in an industrial or commercial enterprise as well as youth leadership capability, provide possible bridges over the yawning gap which I, for one, feel is a matter of increasing concern.

I wonder whether some adult helpers in the Movement in Surrey - especially those recently

retired - might care to think about ways in which some advisory service could be given through groups or districts. Scouts and Venture Scouts who are at school, technical college or university could benefit enormously from first-hand advice which Scouters themselves can only provide at the expense of their normal commitment to Scout training. The latter is itself of great value in any career and should not be diluted. But adult helpers, with available time and appropriate experience, could provide a great service.

Without advice of this kind, young people can only acquire an acquaintance with problems of industry through the media. Inevitably a distorted picture emerges since the media is by nature disposed to report the abnormal (not to say the sensational) rather than the normal.

Would it be feasible to set up - perhaps through the Scout Fellowship - a service to Scouts and Venture Scouts? Perhaps we should think about it.

W. G. WRIGHT

Congratulations

CHIEF SCOUT'S AWARD

Paul Egerton
Mark Humphries
David Murphy
Dean Perry
Hugh Potter
Christopher Voller

Shere and Peaslake
7th Reigate
1st Brookwood
1st Merrow
1st Frimley Green and Mytchett
1st Horley

County Commissioner

It is a sad fact of life that, from time to time, Scouters have to hand in their warrants because increased pressures of business simply do not allow them sufficient time to devote to Scouting. The latest instance of this is that Roy Wood, whose business commitments over the past year or so have been taking him more and more out of the County, and indeed out of the country too, has regretfully had to tender his resignation as Assistant County Commissioner (Scouts).

From the time he took up this appointment, at very short notice in 1972 in the middle of the planning stages for that year's Scoutout held at Stoney Castle, Roy has been a real driving force in Surrey Scouting. He has always been a strong advocate of the Patrol System and has insisted on the maintenance of a high standard of camping and Scouting skills.

Happily we shall not be losing him altogether, for he will remain a member of the County Training Team and so be able to impart to other leaders his own infectious enthusiasm for Scouting.

To succeed him as A.C.C. (Scouts) it gives me the greatest pleasure to welcome back Jim Elliot, my predecessor. Although he moved to Sussex, Jim has continued to keep in close touch with Scouting in Surrey throughout the past four years. He has also remained a member of the County Training Team, though it is only in recent months that he has been able to take an active role. Now Jim is working in

Surrey and plans to move back into the County in the near future. I know he will be warmly welcomed. He takes over from Roy as A.C.C. (Scouts) on 1st March 1978.

For the record there is another change on the County team to report. Sam Smart, A.C.C. (Air Activities), being of the age when it is decreed in P.O.R. that he should lay aside his uniform, has had to tender his resignation from that appointment. Fortunately for us, age restrictions do not apply to Advisers. Within one minute of resigning as an A.C.C. therefore, I am happy to announce that Sam accepted my invitation to become an honorary Commissioner and County Adviser (Air Activities). The "job description" is the same!

Finally, another very good reason for reading our national magazine "Scouting" is that, in addition to being a mine of information, it occasionally includes particulars of fascinating competitions. One such was the "Lyons Savoury Sizzles Superchef" competition. Cub Scouts from the St. George Pack, 1st Cranleigh were among the many entrants. They got through to the finals in the Southern T.V. area held on 11th January in Portsmouth, where they demonstrated their culinary skills before a critical panel of judges and were duly declared the winners! Congratulations to Superchefs Angus Donaldson and Jonathan Ridge who won the £150 prize for their Pack.

GORDON BATES

Water Activities

Congratulations

Congratulations to 'Chiefy' W. R. Sharman, on being awarded the Queen's Jubilee Medal. He has kept very quiet about it, but his ever continuing service and dedication as G.S.L. of "Ajax" Sea Scout Group since 1947 is well known.

Congratulations also, to 1st Cuddington (Warpsite) Sea Scouts who gained second place overall in the Scout Association's National Regatta in October and to 1st Molesey who won the Gargoyle Tiller Trophy for under 13 Dinghy Pulling. After their victories in the Surrey regattas, these achievements are indeed praiseworthy. "Ajax" Sea Scouts also obtained places in several events as usual, ensuring that Surrey remains well to the fore.

Canoeing

With the aid of Kevin Kelly and 'Lofty' Barber of 1st Walton (Vikings) and of Andy Cole and the Canoe Centre, the County ran a successful course for the B.C.U. Elementary Certificate at Send. The course was over three weekends in October and November, resulting in fifteen certificates being gained. 'Lofty' Barber has agreed to organise a follow

up course for the B.C.U. Proficiency Certificate over three weekends in April/May. Notices giving details will be circulated shortly and I hope that all of the people who gained their Elementary will book their places for the Proficiency course quickly, as well as any other Leaders or Scouts who are active in canoeing.

Thanks to Alan Wellstead and other members of 1st Woking, four new canoes have been built for the Canoe Centre. This is the start of re-equipping our Canoe Centre. With our very limited facilities and few instructors at Send, canoeing and instruction have been provided on most Sundays and many Saturdays in 1977. Scouts from around the County have made over 40 bookings and the Centre has been self financing apart from the more costly capital expenditures now planned. It is also hoped to find bigger and better facilities before long, but to make good use of these, more B.C.U. qualified instructors will be required. If you know of a Senior Instructor who would be willing to give some of his time to the Surrey Scout Canoe Centre, please get in touch with me.

Venture Scouts

National Executive Workshop '78

This is a weekend's "experience" for Venture Scouts "interested in developing their Unit's Executive and their own imagination and skills". It will be held at Gilwell Park over the weekend 3rd/5th March and will cost £13.00 which includes indoor accommodation and all food. The programme will include looking at the different ways in which the Executive can work with the Unit, the different jobs that have to be done, working with leaders, parents and Scouts. Programme ideas for evenings, weekends and expeditions are also included. If you are interested, apply to Pauline Greaves, Venture Scout Section, The Scout Association, Gilwell Park, Chingford, London E4 7QW.

ez-en-France

Another weekend for Scout and Venture Scout Leaders and Unit Executive members. Twenty French Leaders will visit Gilwell and London over the weekend 31st March/2nd April to meet twenty English Leaders. There is a full programme and the inclusive cost is £12.00. I have application forms if anyone is interested.

The National Trust

Do Units know that the National Trust welcome parties of young people to do conservation work on its various properties. The Trust is not subsidised at all, so such parties are especially welcome. It sets up camps known as "Acorn Camps" where Units can stay and work from. It has a permanent base camp here in Surrey on the lower slopes of Leith Hill. Parties of up to sixteen people can stay for periods of a week and work under the supervision of the full time warden. This might be an idea for your summer expedition if you are looking for something different, worthwhile and cheap. I have further information for anyone interested.

BRUCE WOOD

Calling all Queen's Scouts

Brigadier B. T. Bastin, C.B.E., T.D., D.L., Chairman of the Surrey County Council is honouring us in this, the Queen's Silver Jubilee year, by holding a Reception at County Hall, Kingston for the Queen's Scouts of our County. It will take place on the evening of April 7th and Bruce Wood (A.C.C. Venture Scouts) is compiling the list of those who can attend.

If you have not already heard about it get into touch, immediately, with your D.C. so that your name can be sent to Bruce. In due course you will be receiving an official invitation giving full details.

FRANK FENTIMAN

Public Relations

If you have not yet got down to the business of planning your Group or District A.G.M., you will undoubtedly have this subject on your agenda this month. The inevitable time for accounts and elections, reports and presentations is almost upon us. I believe the message has got across to most of us by now that an A.G.M. gives us a singular opportunity to have those people we most want to interest themselves in our affairs, be made especially aware of us.

Unfortunately, the truth of the matter is that we do not all succeed in making the most of the opportunity. I hope that the following thoughts may be helpful to you.

1. The date. Ensure, as far as is ever possible, that it does not clash with Cup Finals, Top T.V. programmes, other local events or something else that you really should have remembered.
2. Invite your guests as nicely as possible. Preferably by personalised invitations.
3. For the uninitiated guests, include with your invitation good reasons why they should attend. This can be anything from interest in their children to the well-being of the Group/District, from specific information to free refreshments. You will know your target audience best!
4. Plan your meeting carefully, keep the business short and crisp. Secretaries - if you know your Chairman tends to go on a bit, grasp the nettle and tell him he only has X minutes this year, as you are refreshing the format of the meeting.
5. An A.G.M. allows you to put on anything from a Wine and Cheese party to a Cinema Show. A fork buffet to an exhibition or dinner, be it Fish and Chips, Bangers and Mash or four courses including the best after-dinner speaker of the season. Somewhere in our County at sometime or other all of the above have happened. I am sure we would all like to think that as reasons for making the A.G.M. an occasion, they were more the general rule rather than the exception.
6. Extend your invitations to include local dignitaries, civic church and judiciary, representatives from commercial life, Rotary, and all organisations whom you want to keep informed of your affairs.
7. I am quite certain with that little extra brainstorming, planning and the inevitable slice of added effort that you will feel this years A.G.M. to be something more than a duty chore. Make sure you get an A.G.M. Committee together to see it happens.

Best of luck.

IVAN STAINER

Cub Scouts

The Developed Arrow Programme

As mentioned in the January "Surrey Scout", Eric Daniel, the A.C.C. Cub Scouts for G.L.S.W. and I, together with members of the training team are formulating a joint approach to the Developed Arrow Programme, one result of which will be a number of pilot one day events in both Counties following which it is hoped that these events can be remounted by District teams with our help in the Local situation. Both Eric and I have now attended a number of District Meetings in conjunction with the Developed Arrow Programme and it is apparent from these meetings that there are a number of common areas of concern and I am devoting this portion of "Surrey Scout" to considering some of these items starting with the question of "Guided choice".

With admittedly only a few months experience of the new Programme being worked in various Packs, it is now becoming very apparent that the boys' choice of activities must be guided by Cub Scout Leaders and in making this guidance Leaders must remember that this is a progressive scheme and therefore it will be obvious that from the wide range of activities offered in the Arrow Programme, there are some that are more suitable to the eight year old, some that are more suitable to the nine year old and some which should quite definitely be held back for the older boy. Around our Counties many Leaders have expressed the view that whilst there should be an element of choice and whilst the basic concept is right in that we must accept the boy with the skills that he already has and through his period in the Cub Scout Programme develop these and introduce him to new activities and new skills, nevertheless it can be confusing to see the activities in their present "jumbled" order. I am sure that Leaders will find it more helpful in their programme planning if they could spend an evening with their Assistants in going through the various activities listed and colour coded these as to the activities most suitable to Bronze Arrow, most suitable to Silver Arrow and most suitable to Gold. Of course such an allocation of activities cannot be absolute and flexibility must be maintained in order to cater for the needs of the especially advanced or backward boy but I believe that time spent now in considering these matters will make the day to day running of the Pack and the choice of activities for the boy easier to operate in the future.

Quite apart from the guided choice of activities, we are finding an increasing number of Leaders who are looking at the developments in the Arrow Programme and assuming that Cub Scouting is restricted purely to these activities. This is not the case of course - as with the original Arrow Programme these

activities merely form the stepping stones to gaining the Bronze, Silver and Gold Arrow and there will be many other activities in the Pack Programme either which do not form a direct part of the Arrow Scheme or which do form part of the Arrow Scheme but will be events for all boys irrespective of each boy's choice for his particular Arrow.

In this connection, with the flexibility that there is now, I believe it is of paramount importance that Cub Scout Leaders get together with their Scout colleagues and establish a definite group pattern to ensure that all Cub Scouts receive a basic training that the Scout Leader expects Cub Scouts entering the Troop to have. This is something quite apart from the Arrow Scheme because I believe that there will be many Scout Leaders who will expect all Cub Scouts to have a certain basic training in some activities particularly the Scout Craft type activities, irrespective of whether or not this was the particular choice for individual Arrow Programmes.

Another matter causing great concern is the question of "standards". Here we are hearing comments to the effect that the latest developments will "result in lower standards" or "will produce a multiplicity of standards". These comments we just cannot accept. The "standard" required under the Developed Arrow Programme remains just what it has always been - "The best that a boy can attain". It seems to us that much of the concern stems from the fact that the word "test" no longer appears but it is quite clearly stated in the Programme Booklet forming part of the Cub Scout membership kit that the boy will need to take part **successfully** and **show progress** in each activity. The words "show progress" are of paramount importance and must be used against the basic standard required in all our Cub Scout activities of the boy doing his best. A boy obviously cannot show progress if he merely takes part in one isolated activity - he must persevere with new activities to show that he really has gained a skill and shown progress. However, is this really any different to the former scheme - the only change in our eyes is that the boy has a choice of activities and this does not in any way affect the standard. Under the Developed Arrow Scheme we shall have varying standards between Packs and between individual boys - quite rightly so - but then this also applies under the original Arrow Scheme. All the activities (tests) from the original Arrow Scheme are still available in the Developed Scheme, all that has been done is that additional activities have been put in to give boys a choice and to ensure that instead of merely going through a paper exercise of taking a test for skills already long attained, the boys under the Developed Scheme will in fact try additional activities. In both

Cub Scouts

versions of the Arrow Scheme, some activities (tests) call for an absolute standard e.g. knots either are correct or are not - others are not so clear cut and will be interpreted differently by different Leaders and standards attained will vary from boy to boy.

I firmly believe that the matters of "choice" and "standards" of the Developed Arrow Scheme need considerable airing at District Meetings in order to clear Leaders' minds on just what we are attempting to do and these aspects will be fully considered in the pilot one day events to be mounted during 1978.

DEREK BASSETT

Pieces and Bits

The Chief Constable of Surrey

We congratulate Mr. Peter Matthews, O.B.E., on becoming a Commander of the Royal Victorian Order - Mr. Matthews is a member of the County Scout Council.

"Scouting" Magazine

We have a very kind offer of all 1976 and 1977 copies of "Scouting", anyone who would like these please contact the editor - first come, first served!

Leader Training Courses

General Information Course

Sutton 5th March
Woking 12th March

Pack Holiday Course

Bentley Copse 1st/2nd April

Basic Courses

CUB SCOUT LEADERS

Croydon 11th/12th February
Woking 18th/19th February

Merton 4th/5th March
Sutton 1st/2nd April

SCOUT LEADERS

Surbiton 25th/26th February
Bentley Copse (residential) 18th/19th March

VENTURE SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse 4th/5th March

GROUP SCOUT LEADERS

Dorking 4th/5th February

Advanced Courses

CUB SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse 20th/21st & 27th/29th May
G.L.S.W. Area To be announced

SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse 3rd/4th, 17th/18th June & 1st/2nd July
Bentley Copse 9th/10th September
29th September/1st October
14th/15th October

VENTURE SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse 23rd/24th September & 21st/22nd October

G.S.L.s/COMMISSIONERS

Bentley Copse Autumn 1978

I. Gunn, 19 Kendal Gardens, Sutton.
Mrs. D. Martin, 103 Lovelace Drive, Pyrford.

Mrs. W. Viner, 58 West Bank, Dorking.

Mrs. M. Walden, 31 Langton Way, Croydon.
Mrs. J. Fentiman, "Woodside", Meadow Way, Great Bookham.

Miss M. Pooley, 71 Beech Grove, Mitcham.
S. Street, 15 Summerville Gardens, Cheam.

D. Barker, 3 Oriental Close, Woking.
R.D. Wood, 2, Ashley Close, Frimley Green, Camberley

B. Wood, 36 Sole Farm Road, Great Bookham.

E.J. Walden, 31 Langton Way, Croydon.

F. Fentiman, 'Woodside', Meadow Way, Great Bookham.
Mrs. M. Walden, 31 Langton Way, Croydon.

R.D. Wood, 2, Ashley Close, Frimley Green, Camberley.

R.D. Wood, 2, Ashley Close, Frimley Green, Camberley.

B.C. Wood, 36 Sole Farm Road, Great Bookham.

D. Barrell, 1 Beech Road, Reigate.

County Chaplain

"Basically we're all selfish, we all look after number one whatever we like to think we are doing - it's only human". I hear remarks like that quite often in my job, not least from younger people. The people who say this are not usually vicious or nasty, they just find it difficult to believe that there is such a thing as real human selflessness. Often they have been influenced (as we all have) by the findings of anthropologists and psychologists that seem to imply that beneath our suits, dresses and uniforms we are all hiding the character of acquisitive animals. And, to be honest, we can hardly deny that there's a 'what's in it for me' streak running almost as far through our personalities as the 'Brighton' in Brighton rock.

But a Cub Scout is still supposed to be someone who 'thinks of others before himself', and although

the words of the Law are different, the intention for all other members of the Movement is surely the same - to put others first and leave self a bit behind. We can all recognise that this is part of the message of Jesus; but are we convinced that it makes sense today, and can we convince others?

After a good few arguments on this theme I have to say that I doubt whether debate can decide the issue one way or the other. My words can't prove to anyone that selfless care for others happens and works today as much as ever it did. But I can point to the only proof there is - outstanding human beings living that way day by day in every corner of the world. There is no better way of teaching young people than pointing them to a living example - except the way of becoming examples ourselves.

PETER FISHER

County Diary

February

5	District Officials' Conference	Dorking
7	Cub Scout Sub-Committee	Leatherhead
12	Scout First Aid Competition	Farnham
25	Chief Scout's Award Presentation	East Surrey

March

2	Venture Scout Sub-Committee	Dorking
6	V.S. Rifle Club A.G.M.	Ashted
11	Scout Fellowship Sub-Committee	West Ewell
27	Scout Job Week	

April

3	Programme & Training Sub-Committee	Bookham
10	Scout Sub-Committee	Leatherhead
12	County Executive	B.-P. House
15	D.C.s Symposium	Bentley Copse
23	National Scout Service	Windsor

May

24	Cub Scout Sub-Committee	Leatherhead
27	National Chief Scout Award Camp begins	

June

1	Venture Scout Sub-Committee	Dorking
2	County Annual General Meeting	Esher
24	Chief Scout's Award Presentation	Sunbury & Shepperton
30	Programme & Training Sub-Committee	Dorking

July

3	Scout Sub-Committee	Leatherhead
12	County Executive	B.-P. House

September

1/2/3	Gilwell Reunion	Gilwell
15/16	National Commissioners Conference	Loughborough
17		Dorking
21	Venture Scout Sub-Committee	Walton Firs
23/24	Scout Camping Competition	

October

2	Scout Sub-Committee	Leatherhead
3	Programme & Training Sub-Committee	
7/8	A.D.C. (Cub Scouts) Training Weekend	
11	County Executive	B.-P. House
14	Chief Scout's Award Presentation	Haslemere
14	Queen Scouts Reception	London

December

7	Venture Scout Sub-Committee	Dorking
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March "Surrey Scout"

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